German Idealism Reading Group

Columbia University

Faculty Sponsor: Axel Honneth

Meetings: Fridays, 4-6pm in Nous Café, Philosophy Hall

Topic: Book II of Hegel's *Science of Logic*. The Doctrine of Essence.

Description: We'll work through the second book of Hegel's *Logic*, the first part of Hegel's 'philosophical' system. The topics included in this book are essence, semblance, reflection, identity, difference, contradiction, ground, things and their properties, laws, the world, the whole and its parts, force and its expression, the inner and the outer, substance, accidentality, causality, power, and the initial formation of the concept.

Schedule of Readings

Week **Reading(s)**

1 Introduction to the Doctrine of Essence

- Hegel, "The Doctrine of Essence" in the *Science of Logic*
- Hegel, "Shine" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §112-§114 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*
- Winfield, "13. From Measure to Essence" & "14. Essence" in *Hegel's Science of Logic*

2 Identity and Difference

- Hegel, pp. 354-367 in "The Essentialities or Determinations of Reflection" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §115-§118 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*
- Winfield, "15. Essence as Reflection Within Itself" in *Hegel's Science of Logic*

3 Opposition and Contradiction

- Hegel, pp. 367-385 in "The Essentialities or Determinations of Reflection" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §119-§120 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*
- Winfield, "16. From Reflection to Existence" in *Hegel's Science of Logic*

4 The Structure of Grounding

- Hegel, pp. 386-402 in "Ground" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §121 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*

5 Real and Complete Grounds

- Hegel, pp. 402-417 in "Ground" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §122 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*

6 Appearance, Things, Properties

- Hegel, "Appearance" in the *Science of Logic*
- Hegel, pp. 420-430 in "Concrete Existence" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §123-§127 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*
- Winfield, "17. From Appearance to Actuality" in *Hegel's Science of Logic*

7 Matters and Laws of Appearance

- Hegel, pp. 430-436 in "Concrete Existence" in the *Science of Logic*
- Hegel, pp. 437-443 in "Appearance" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §128-§131 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*

8 The World, the Whole, and Force

- Hegel, pp. 443-448 in "Appearance" in the *Science of Logic*
- Hegel, pp. 449-459 in "The Essential Relation" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §132-§137 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*

9 Actuality and the Absolute

- Hegel, pp. 460-464 in "The Essential Relation" in the *Science of Logic*
- Hegel, "Actuality" in the *Science of Logic*
- Hegel, "The Absolute" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §138-§141 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*

10 Modality

- Hegel, "Actuality" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §142-§149 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*

11 Substance, Causality, and Interaction

- Hegel, "The Absolute Relation" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §150-§159 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*
- Winfield, "18. Transition to the Concept" in *Hegel's Science of Logic*

12 Transition to the Subjective Logic

- Hegel, "Foreword" to the Subjective Logic in the *Science of Logic*
- Hegel, "On the Concept in General" in the *Science of Logic*

Optional further readings:

- Hegel, §160-§163 in the *Encyclopedia Logic*
- Winfield, "19. The Concept" in *Hegel's Science of Logic*